CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

HOME STAGER IN THE AI ERA

Homes sell with the eyes first — staging is the art of making a stranger feel 'mine' within eight seconds of the door opening.

★ TL;DR — Around $75K median for stagers who build a portfolio and agent relationships in 1–6 months, no license required. The catch: you need inventory, storage and muscles — sofas do not move themselves. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

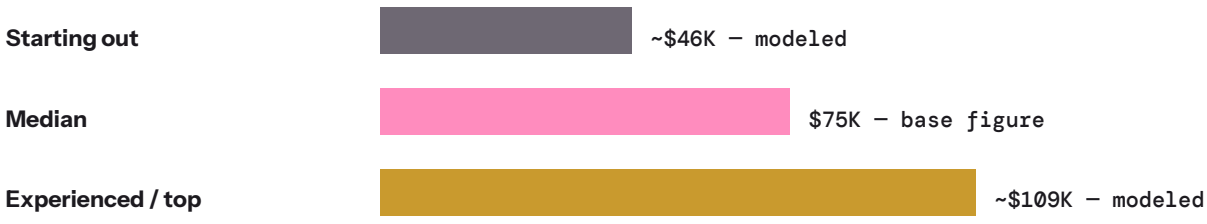
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Why it works: staged homes photograph better, list better, and agents know it — you sell to the agent as much as the owner.
- Where it bites: furniture inventory and moving logistics are your capital and your cardio.
- The AI angle: virtual staging fills cheap listings with fake sofas — premium listings still pay for real rooms buyers can walk through.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Home Stager is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A HOME STAGER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Walk listed homes and plan what stays, goes and gets added
- ✓ Install furniture, art and styling that makes rooms read bigger and warmer
- ✓ Photograph-ready every space for the listing shoot
- ✓ De-stage on sale, warehouse the inventory, repeat

Think: a set designer for the theatre of real estate — every room performs for one audience: the buyer.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Virtual staging software decorates empty rooms in listing photos for pocket change, and AI copy writes the descriptions. The low end of the market is already digital.	Real staging is physical and persuasive: editing a lived-in home with the owner's feelings attached, placing real furniture in real light, and advising agents honestly on price-killing flaws.

⚠ **Inventory is the barrier nobody mentions: a credible starter set of furniture and decor costs real money before your first fee arrives.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Transformation work — before/afters sell themselves ✓ Project rhythm: intense install days, quiet gaps ✓ Agents feed repeat work when you perform	✗ Moving furniture is the job, not a side effect ✗ Storage rent and truck logistics every month ✗ Income follows the housing market's moods

Good fit? You have decorator instincts, realtor energy and no fear of a furniture dolly.
Bad fit? You want pure design work with no hauling, storage or salesmanship.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — WORK FOR A STAGING COMPANY	DOOR B — SOLO WITH LEAN INVENTORY
Established stagers hire installers and junior stylists. You learn inventory systems, agent relationships and what actually photographs — while someone else owns the warehouse and the truck.	Start with occupied-home consultations and light staging using the owner's pieces plus a small kit of decor. Low capital, fast start — you sell your eye before you own a warehouse of sofas.

Smart move: Sell agents a standing service: every new listing gets a staging consult within 48 hours. Being their default button beats competing job by job.
Where you land after: A staging company with warehouse, crew and agent contracts — or a premium niche in luxury listings.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN WHAT	BUILD A	GET INSTALL	ASSEMBLE YOUR	SIGN YOUR	GROW INVENTORY

STEP 1 — Learn what photographs

FREE · WEEKS 1-2

- Study listing photos: what reads spacious, warm, expensive
- Staging rules: depersonalize, define rooms, light everything

STEP 2 — Build a starter portfolio

$0-300 · MONTH 1

- Stage rooms in your own and friends' homes
- Before/afters shot like listings, not snapshots

STEP 3 — Get install experience

PAID · MONTHS 1-3

- Work installs for a staging company or busy stager
- Learn the logistics: wrapping, loading, protecting floors

STEP 4 — Assemble your kit

$500+ · MONTHS 2-4

- Neutral decor, bedding, art and small furniture that fits anywhere
- Storage and transport solved before you need them

STEP 5 — Sign your first agents

MONTHS 3-5

- Pitch listing agents with your before/afters
- Offer a fast consult product as the entry drug

STEP 6 — Grow inventory with demand

MONTHS 5-6

- Buy pieces your bookings keep asking for
- Every purchase must earn its storage space

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: study ten listing photo sets and name what staging did in each.

- Days 1–30: stage and photograph rooms you can access; build the portfolio.
- Days 31–60: work installs with a staging company; start your decor kit.
- Days 61–90: pitch agents with before/afters; book consults and first full stages.
- Day 90: a working stager with agent relationships — inventory grows behind bookings.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ SELL THE FEELING, NOT THE FURNITURE. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.